

8-Week Half Ironman (70.3) Training Plan

Peak Phase for Experienced Athletes

Race Distance: 1.9km Swim | 90km Bike | 21.1km Run

Target Audience: Athletes with established base fitness and triathlon experience

Prerequisites: Able to swim 1km, bike 60 min, run 45 min continuously

Weekly Training: 6 days per week | 8-10 hours total

Program Structure: Intensive peak phase with race simulation

Program Overview

This 8-week intensive program is designed for athletes with solid aerobic base fitness who are ready for a focused peak phase. It assumes you've completed a base-building phase and are now focused on race-specific preparation and peak performance.

Key Principles:

- High intensity with strategic recovery
 - Race-specific workout durations
 - Multiple brick workouts
 - Nutrition practice during long sessions
 - Progressive taper in final 2 weeks
-

WEEK 1: Establish Baseline & Intensity

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Swim Intervals (45 min)

- Warm-up: 5 min easy swim
- Main Set: 10 x 3 min at race pace with 1 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 5 min easy swim

Wednesday: Easy Bike (50 min)

- Entire session easy/conversational pace

Thursday: Run Intervals (60 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog
- Main Set: 8 x 5 min at race pace with 1.5 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 8 min easy walk/jog

Friday: Easy Swim (20 min)

- Swim easy, focus on form

Saturday: Long Bike (120 min)

- Warm-up: 15 min easy
- Main Set: 90 min at easy/conversational pace
- Cool-down: 15 min easy
- *Practice nutrition every 45 min*

Sunday: Long Run (60 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog
- Main Set: 45 min at easy/conversational pace
- Cool-down: 5 min easy walk

Weekly Volume: ~9 hours

WEEK 2: Build Intensity

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Swim Intervals (50 min)

- Warm-up: 5 min easy swim
- Main Set: 12 x 3 min at race pace with 1 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 5 min easy swim

Wednesday: Easy Bike (50 min)

Thursday: Run Intervals (65 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog
- Main Set: 10 x 4 min at race pace with 1 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 8 min easy walk/jog

Friday: Easy Swim (20 min)

Saturday: Bike + Run Brick (150 min)

- Bike: 15 min warm-up, 100 min at race pace, 10 min cool-down
- Transition: 5 min
- Run: 20 min easy into race pace
- *Critical race simulation*

Sunday: Easy Run (45 min)

Weekly Volume: ~9.5 hours

WEEK 3: Peak Intensity

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Swim Intervals (50 min)

- Warm-up: 5 min easy swim
- Main Set: 6 x 5 min at race pace with 1 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 5 min easy swim

Wednesday: Easy Bike (50 min)

Thursday: Run Intervals (70 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog
- Main Set: 6 x 6 min at race pace with 1.5 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 8 min easy walk/jog

Friday: Easy Swim (20 min)

Saturday: Long Bike (150 min)

- Warm-up: 15 min easy
- Main Set: 120 min at race pace
- Cool-down: 15 min easy
- *Full race distance bike simulation*

Sunday: Long Run (70 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog
- Main Set: 55 min at easy/conversational pace
- Cool-down: 5 min easy walk

Weekly Volume: ~10 hours

WEEK 4: Recovery Week (Taper Begins)

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Swim (40 min)

- Warm-up: 5 min easy swim
- Main Set: 6 x 3 min at race pace with 1 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 5 min easy swim

Wednesday: Easy Bike (40 min)

Thursday: Run (50 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog

- Main Set: 4 x 4 min at race pace with 2 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 8 min easy walk/jog

Friday: Easy Swim (15 min)

Saturday: Easy Bike (40 min)

Sunday: Easy Run (35 min)

Weekly Volume: ~5 hours

WEEK 5: Return to Intensity

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Swim Intervals (50 min)

- Warm-up: 5 min easy swim
- Main Set: 8 x 4 min at race pace with 1 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 5 min easy swim

Wednesday: Easy Bike (50 min)

Thursday: Run Intervals (65 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog
- Main Set: 8 x 5 min at race pace with 1 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 8 min easy walk/jog

Friday: Easy Swim (20 min)

Saturday: Full Triathlon Simulation (180 min)

- Swim: 30 min easy (simulating 1.9km)
- Transition: 5 min
- Bike: 90 min at race pace (simulating 90km)
- Transition: 5 min
- Run: 30 min easy (simulating 21.1km)

- *Your final full dress rehearsal*

Sunday: Easy Run (45 min)

Weekly Volume: ~9 hours

WEEK 6: Peak Week

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Swim Intervals (50 min)

- Warm-up: 5 min easy swim
- Main Set: 10 x 4 min at race pace with 1 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 5 min easy swim

Wednesday: Easy Bike (50 min)

Thursday: Run Intervals (70 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog
- Main Set: 8 x 5 min at race pace with 1 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 8 min easy walk/jog

Friday: Easy Swim (20 min)

Saturday: Bike + Run Brick (150 min)

- Bike: 15 min warm-up, 100 min at race pace, 10 min cool-down
- Transition: 5 min
- Run: 20 min easy into race pace
- *Final hard effort before taper*

Sunday: Easy Run (50 min)

Weekly Volume: ~9.5 hours

WEEK 7: Begin Final Taper

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Swim (40 min)

- Warm-up: 5 min easy swim
- Main Set: 6 x 3 min at race pace with 1 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 5 min easy swim

Wednesday: Easy Bike (40 min)

Thursday: Run (50 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog
- Main Set: 4 x 4 min at race pace with 2 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 8 min easy walk/jog

Friday: Easy Swim (15 min)

Saturday: Easy Bike (40 min)

Sunday: Easy Run (35 min)

Weekly Volume: ~5 hours

WEEK 8: RACE WEEK

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Easy Swim (20 min)

- Very easy, confidence-building

Wednesday: Rest day

Thursday: Easy Bike (30 min)

- Very easy, just moving

Friday: Easy Swim (15 min)

- Short and easy

Saturday: Rest day - Final preparations

- Lay out all gear
- Review race plan
- Eat familiar foods
- Hydrate well

Sunday: RACE DAY!

- Arrive 1-2 hours early
- Warm up gently in water
- Review your race plan
- Trust your 8 weeks of training
- Have fun and celebrate!

Weekly Volume: ~1 hour

Race-Day Strategy

Pre-Race (2-3 hours before):

- Familiar breakfast: oatmeal with banana and honey
- Hydrate with water and electrolytes
- Arrive early for parking and setup

30 Min Before Race:

- Light snack: banana or energy bar
- Final hydration and bathroom break

During Swim (1.9km, ~30-40 min):

- Focus on pacing and breathing

- Start slightly conservative
- No nutrition needed

Bike (90km, ~3-4 hours):

- Start nutrition at 45 min mark
- Every 45 min: 1 energy bar or 2 energy gels
- Every 30 min: 500ml sports drink or water with electrolytes
- Aim for 200-300 calories per hour
- Maintain steady effort, don't go too hard

Run (21.1km, ~2-3 hours):

- Start nutrition at 15 min mark
- Every 20 min: 1 energy gel or sports drink
- Walk through aid stations if needed
- Focus on hydration - drink at every station
- Pace conservatively first 5km, build in middle 10km, push final 6km

Post-Race:

- Within 30 min: Protein + carbs (chocolate milk, recovery drink, sandwich)
- Rehydrate with electrolytes
- Rest, celebrate, and reflect on your achievement!

Training Zones Explained

Easy/Conversational (60-70% max HR): You can speak in full sentences. This is recovery pace.

Steady (70-80% max HR): You can speak short phrases. This is aerobic building pace.

Race Pace (80-90% max HR): You can speak a few words. This is your goal race effort.

Hard (90-100% max HR): You cannot speak. This is maximum effort intervals.

Nutrition During Training

Pre-Workout (30-60 min before):

- Banana with almond butter
- Toast with jam
- Rice cakes with honey
- *Something light and easily digestible*

During Workout (sessions >90 min):

- Water with electrolytes
- Energy gels or sports drink
- 1 energy bar per 45 min

Post-Workout (within 30 min):

- Protein + carbs (chicken with rice, protein smoothie, turkey sandwich)
 - Rehydrate with electrolytes
 - *Critical for recovery*
-

Recovery & Injury Prevention

Sleep: Aim for 8-9 hours per night. This is when adaptation happens.

Stretching: 10-15 min after each workout, especially legs and shoulders.

Foam Rolling: 5-10 min on rest days for muscle recovery.

Massage: Monthly professional massage or self-massage with foam roller.

Listen to Your Body: If something hurts (not just tired), take an extra rest day.

Cross-Training: Optional easy yoga or swimming on rest days.

Week-by-Week Summary

Week	Focus	Volume	Key Workout
1	Establish Baseline	9 hrs	Long bike (120 min) + run (60 min)
2	Build Intensity	9.5 hrs	Bike + run brick (150 min)
3	Peak Intensity	10 hrs	Long bike (150 min) at race pace
4	Recovery	5 hrs	Reduced volume, maintain intensity
5	Return to Intensity	9 hrs	Full triathlon simulation (180 min)
6	Peak Week	9.5 hrs	Bike + run brick (150 min)
7	Begin Taper	5 hrs	Reduced volume, maintain intensity
8	RACE WEEK	1 hr	RACE DAY!

Race Week Checklist

- ☐ Lay out all gear the night before
 - ☐ Check weather forecast
 - ☐ Review race course map
 - ☐ Plan parking and arrival time (arrive 1-2 hours early)
 - ☐ Practice race-day breakfast
 - ☐ Get good sleep 2-3 nights before
 - ☐ Reduce training volume by 80%
 - ☐ Maintain intensity but reduce duration
 - ☐ Eat familiar foods only
 - ☐ Hydrate consistently
-

Post-Race Recovery

Congratulations on completing your half ironman! Now:

- Rest for 5-7 days with easy movement only
- Reflect on what went well and what to improve
- Consider your next goal (another 70.3, full ironman, or new distance)
- Celebrate your amazing achievement!

Remember: This is YOUR training plan. Adjust rest days as needed to fit your life. Consistency beats perfection. Trust the process and have fun!